

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday June 10, 2021

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #51, June 10, 2021

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:02 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (9/11): Francesco Cesarini, Sophie DeBenedetto, Maxim Fedorov, Kenneth Lundin, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, Bryan Paxton, Miriam Pena Villanueva, and Alistair Woodman.

The following members of the board of directors were absent: Richard Carlsson, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #50 held on May 27, 2021. Unanimously approved.

2. Intermediate actions: Sebastian has activated the EEF credit card and started transferring billing of our services to it.
3. Treasury report: about \$145K in the bank (currently expenses and sponsor donations are roughly matching, Sebastian will put together a status report of spendings, and outstanding payments and receivable for next meeting).
Membership update: Annual Supporting members: 131 (+1), Lifetime Supporting members: 14 (+1), Basic members: 711 (+11).

4. No unanimous consent vote scheduled.

5. Stipend Proposals

1. PromEx proposal. Sophie presented the details of the proposal (presentation attached) for \$3500 to fund six week of feature development work for PromEx. The suggestion is that the Observability Working Group is the “home” for the project.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the stipend request for \$3500 for the PromEx project as requested. Unanimously approved.

2. Backend Platform in Elixir. Bryan reached out and asked some sanity check questions, but have not heard back.
6. Any other business.
 1. Francesco reminded us about Code BEAM in November at the Computer History Museum in Mountain View. Short discussion around what EEF can do at the conference and how to participate.
 2. Miriam is working on streamlining the process to sponsor students and diversity tickets to conferences.
7. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 16:42 UTC.

Dated June 10, 2021

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. PromEx project Stipend Request (2 pages)
2. PromEx project presentation (7 pages)

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : Development Work

First name : Alexander

Last Name : Koutmos

Nick Name :

Email Address : akoutmos@gmail.com

Phone Number : (203) 512-5822

Organization Name :

City : East Hampton

Region : CT

Postal Code : 06424

Country : United States

Twitter : @akoutmos

Linkedin : <https://www.linkedin.com/in/alex-koutmos-b8b2bb93/>

Website : <https://akoutmos.com/>

Intended product of project :

The PromEx project (https://github.com/akoutmos/prom_ex) aims to provide a turn key observability solution for Elixir applications (Prometheus metrics and Grafana dashboards in less than 5 minutes to be exact ;)). It does so by leveraging the community Telemetry tooling to provide Prometheus metrics and Grafana dashboards for community libraries such as Phoenix, LiveView, Ecto, Oban, and even the BEAM itself.

Purpose

The reason for this stipend request is to aid in the development of the PromEx library that is published on Hex (https://hex.pm/packages/prom_ex). There are currently a few big items on the upcoming feature list that will greatly improve the observability experience for all Elixir applications and in particular applications running on Gigalixir/Heroku/ECS. This would be in addition to providing dashboards for other open source Elixir projects like Broadway, Absinthe and Finch. Specifically, the goals that would be achievable with this stipend would be: - Prometheus metrics and a Grafana dashboard for Absinthe (<https://hex.pm/packages/absinthe>) - Prometheus metrics and a Grafana dashboard for Finch (<https://hex.pm/packages/finch>) - Packaging of GrafanaAgent in PromEx so that library users can push metrics to Prometheus instances (https://github.com/akoutmos/prom_ex/issues/44) - Completion of the Broadway PromEx plugin and Grafana dashboard (https://github.com/akoutmos/prom_ex/pull/39)

Development Plan

The goal would be to finish and deliver the aforementioned features in the next 6 weeks, with development all being done by myself. With a stipend from the EEF, I could forego any kind of consulting work for the next 6 weeks, which will free up my time to focus on this open source library. The breakdown of time would be as follows: - 3 weeks on

integrating the GrafanaAgent - 1 week for the Absinthe PromEx plugin - 1 week for the Broadway PromEx plugin - 1 week for the Finch PromEx plugin

Dissemination : As features are completed, I will be posting updates on my Twitter account, my blog and perhaps later this year, I will give another conference talk on the project to let the community know how it is evolving since my last Code BEAM V America presentation.

Delivery Method : As features reach completion, new versions of PromEx will be published to Hex and will be announced on all the platforms where I have a presence.

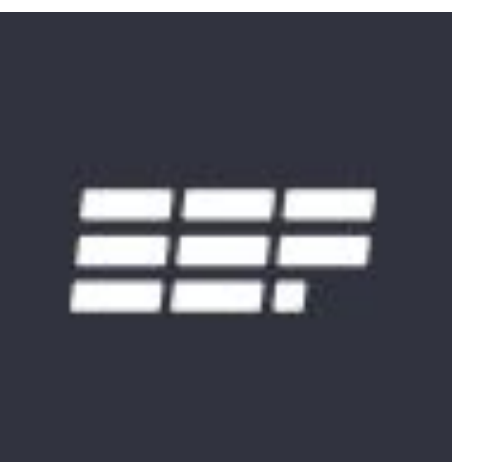
Stipend Amount (USD) : 3500

Payment Method : Check

PromEx Library Development

Develop PromEx to improve the observability experience for all Elixir applications

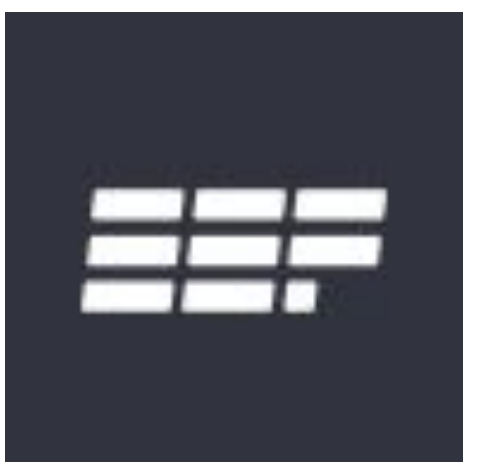
Proposal by Alex Koutmos



PromEx Status

A turn-key observability solution for Elixir applications

- [PromEx](#) is built on top of the Telemetry, TelemetryMetricsPrometheus.Core and TelemetryPoller libraries
 - Many contributions have been made back to beam-telemetry projects and other libraries in order to bolster Telemetry events (Broadway and Oban for example)
- PromEx currently provides Prometheus metrics and Grafana dashboards for:
 - Phoenix and LiveView
 - Ecto
 - Oban
 - BEAM
- Currently gets about 350 downloads a day with a number of companies already using it



Dashboard Examples



Ecto Grafana Dashboard



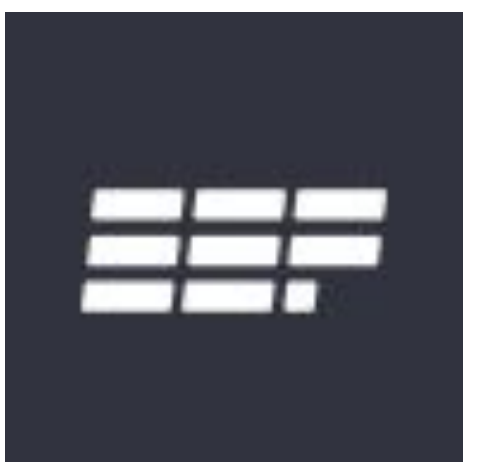
BEAM Grafana Dashboard



Project Goals

New feature development for the PromEx library that builds on in-flight work

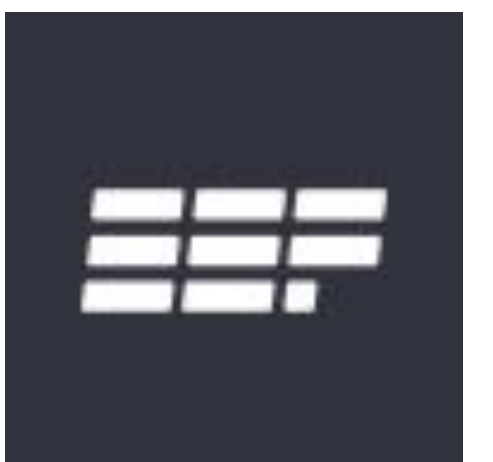
- Improves the observability experience for all Elixir applications, in particular applications running on Gigalixir/Heroku/ECS
- Provide dashboards and metrics for Broadway, Absinthe and Finch:
 - Prometheus metrics and a Grafana dashboard for [Absinthe](#)
 - Prometheus metrics and a Grafana dashboard for [Finch](#)
 - Completion of the [Broadway PromEx plugin and Grafana dashboard](#)
- [Packaging of GrafanaAgent in PromEx](#) so that library users can push metrics to Prometheus instances as opposed to only pulling



Project Impact

Improving observability in the Elixir ecosystem

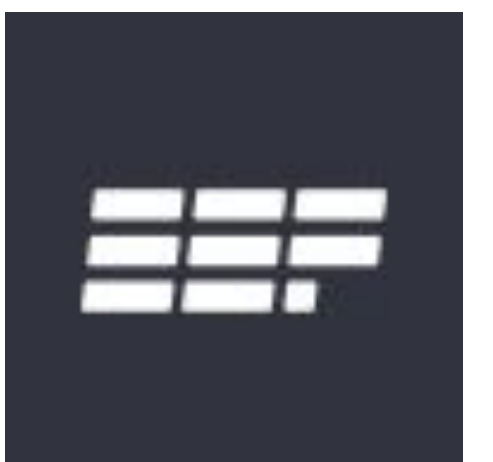
- **Improved observability** for common Elixir open source libraries.
- **Easy, low-barrier observability** tooling for Elixir app developers.
- **PromEx plugins can be written for Erlang** libraries that use Telemetry. And, the PromEx Grafana Client and Agent do inter-op with Erlang.
- The patterns explored in PromEx (specifically the ability for applications to control the lifecycle of their dashboards and annotate deployment markers) are of interest to the broader [observability community](#)
- **Increased Elixir adoption:** The easy-to-set up observability solution makes Elixir easier language to bring into your stack.



Project Delivery Plan

6 weeks of work delivered by library author and maintainer Alex Koutmos

- **Phase 1:** 3 weeks on integrating the GrafanaAgent
- **Phase 2:** 1 week for the Absinthe PromEx plugin
- **Phase 3:** 1 week for the Broadway PromEx plugin
- **Phase 4:** 1 week for the Finch PromEx plugin
- Each phase will be accompanied by updates over Twitter and other community channels. Project completion will be accompanied by at least one blog post and submission to give conference talks on this topic.
- Each phase will be concluded with a new PromEx release over Hex.



Stipend Request Details

- **Deliverables**

- A new release of the PromEx library to delivery increased observability of the Broadway, Absinthe and Finch libraries, as well as increased observability capabilities for all PromEx library users, including those running Elixir apps on GigElixir, Heroku, ECS.
- Regular blog posts, Twitter updates, and updates in other community forums to popularize the PromEx library and socialize observability tooling and goals in the Elixir community.

- **Cost**

- A stipend amount of \$3500 USD to be paid to Alex Koutmos to support a 6 week development project

